REAR WINDOW: BEHIND THE SCENES

- **DIRECTOR: Antonio Amaya/ Samantha Guzman**
- **ASSISTANT DIRECTOR (MC): Jeronimo Bustos /Luciana Peña**
- **MAKEUP MASTER: Veronica/Mariana**
- **JEFF: Nicolas Paez/Valentina Camargo**
- **LISA: Isabella Atencia /Ana S. Pulido**
- **THORWALD: Martina Mendieta /Maria Antonia Ortega**
- **DETECTIVE: Juan Antonio Diaz./Lorenzo Arango**
- **MISS LONELYHEARTS: Sara S. Bohorquez/Maria Isabel Velasquez**
- **ARTIST: Tomas Alvarez / Sara L. Zapata**
- **CAMERA MAN: Geronimo Pedraza /Juan Esteban Martinez**
- **PROP MASTER: Martin Pedraza /Gabriela Manosalva**
- **Ceremony Master: Valeria Ortiz**

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Ceremony Master: Valeria

Running rule: the CAMERA MAN claps the clapperboard before every film scene. Either the DIRECTOR or CAMERA MAN calls "ACTION!" to begin — the DIRECTOR always calls "CUT!" to end. CUT means we're back in real life (backstage).

CEREMONY MASTER VALERIA (welcoming, big smile) Good evening, everyone! Welcome to Stage 18 — well, our classroom's version of it! Tonight, our 4th graders take you behind the scenes of a real 1954 film shoot. Please welcome our cast!

SCENE ONE: WELCOME TO STAGE 18 (Beginning)

The DIRECTOR stands center with a cardboard megaphone. MAKEUP MASTER is powdering JEFF/JESSY's face. CAMERA MAN adjusts a cardboard camera. THORWALD and DETECTIVE stretch in the corner.

DIRECTOR (loud, proud, arms wide) *Welcome to Stage 18, Paramount Studios! Summer, 1954! Biggest indoor set ever built! Don't break anything!*

ASSISTANT DIRECTOR (worried, pointing up) *Director! The lights are flickering!*

LISA (looking up, half-joking) *Ooh, spooky! That actually looks kind of perfect for a*

mystery movie.

DIRECTOR (snapping fingers) *Fix it! And find Thorwald's suitcase!*

PROP MASTER (holding empty suitcase) *I have it — but it's empty! ...Wait, I'll put rocks inside! Problem solved!*

DETECTIVE (stretching, practicing a walk) *My tough-guy walk needs practice. Watch this!*

THORWALD (chest out, flexing) *Ha! I'm the scariest man in Hollywood! Nobody does menacing like me!*

JEFF/JESSY (grinning, teasing) *Big words, Thorwald! Let's see it in the scene later.*

THORWALD laughs loudly — but his smile fades the moment he turns away.

ASSISTANT DIRECTOR (quiet, private) *You okay, Thorwald? You seem quiet all of a sudden.*

THORWALD (dropping the act, honest) *This is my first big villain scene. What if I'm not scary enough?*

ASSISTANT DIRECTOR (kind, hand on his shoulder) *Being nervous doesn't mean you can't do it. Even brave people get scared sometimes.*

THORWALD (forcing a smile, louder) *Right! Of course! Scariest man in Hollywood, remember?*

He walks off, not fully convinced. JEFF/JESSY, nearby with camera, quietly watches.

JEFF/JESSY (to self, thoughtful) *Interesting... I should remember that.*

MAKEUP MASTER (finishing touches) *Hold still! Almost done — perfect for the close-up.*

MAKEUP MASTER (stepping back, satisfied) *There! Now you look ready for your close-up.*

LISA (warm, to JEFF/JESSY) *You'll be great. We're all here.*

CAMERA MAN raises the clapperboard.

CAMERA MAN (loud, official) *Rear Window! Scene One, Take One!*

DIRECTOR (raising hand) *Places, everyone! ...And ACTION!*

FILM SCENE BEGINS. JEFF/JESSY sits in a wheelchair with binoculars. LISA stands behind.

JEFF/JESSY (acting, pointing) *Look! Miss Lonelyhearts is crying again.*

LISA (acting, scolding gently) *You shouldn't spy on people!*

JEFF/JESSY (acting, defensive) *Spying? I'm a photographer! I observe!*

THORWALD (acting, confident) *Is my hair scary enough for the close-up?*

JEFF/JESSY (acting, suspicious) *Wait... what's Thorwald doing with that suitcase?*

DIRECTOR (clapping once) *CUT!*

CEREMONY MASTER VALERIA (warm, to audience) For this next scene, our Artist will really play — no pretending! Parents, listen closely, this song is for you too.

SCENE TWO: THE ARTIST'S SONG (Rising Action)

LONELYHEARTS area is set up. ARTIST holds a real small instrument.

CAMERA MAN (clapperboard) *Scene Two, Take One!*

DIRECTOR (gentle) *Scene Two. The artist and the lonely heart. ...ACTION!*

FILM SCENE BEGINS. ARTIST really plays a slow, soft tune.

MISS LONELYHEARTS (crying softly) *Please... stop. That song reminds me of what I lost.*

ARTIST (stopping, gentle) *I'm sorry. I didn't mean to make you cry.*

MISS LONELYHEARTS (wiping eyes, small smile) *It's not your fault. Memories just come back.*

ARTIST (thoughtful) *Sometimes music brings out what we hide inside.*

MISS LONELYHEARTS (curious) *What are you making?*

ARTIST (proud, holding up clay — visible to audience) *Look — something beautiful. Like you.*

MISS LONELYHEARTS (touched, hand to chest) *That's the kindest thing anyone has said to me in a long time.*

DIRECTOR (clapping, loud) *CUT! Beautiful!*

MISS LONELYHEARTS (laughing) *I couldn't stop crying! That song got to me!*

ARTIST (laughing too) *I was trying to play happy music, but my fingers kept playing sad notes!*

MAKEUP MASTER (rushing over with powder) *Your tears ruined your makeup! Hold still!*

PROP MASTER (worried) *My clay is drying out! I need more!*

DETECTIVE (helpful, jumping in) *I'll get clay from the prop room! Fastest runner here!*

CAMERA MAN (catching a falling prop camera) *Got it! And I still got the emotional shot!*

LISA (to JEFF/JESSY, noticing) *You're quiet today. Just observing again?*

JEFF/JESSY (shrugging) *Just observing. That's what I do.*

MISS LONELYHEARTS (gently) *Sometimes observing isn't enough. Sometimes people need us to say something.*

CEREMONY MASTER VALERIA (playful, to audience) Uh oh — looks like there's a music problem on set! Parents, get ready... you might be asked to help solve it!

SCENE 2.5: THE PLAYLIST PROBLEM (Rising Action)

PROP MASTER and ASSISTANT DIRECTOR run in holding a portable speaker.

PROP MASTER (excited) *Director! We need music for the break! I have three ideas!*

DIRECTOR (impatient) *Fine. Play something.*

Trend/dance clip #1 plays — upbeat modern trend. Cast dances.

DIRECTOR (covering ears, grumpy) *NO! Too much noise! This is Hollywood, not Broadway!*

THORWALD (arms crossed, stiff) *Scary men don't dance.*

DETECTIVE (nudging him, grinning) *Come on, Thorwald, live a little!*

THORWALD (firm) *No. I have a reputation.*

ASSISTANT DIRECTOR (laughing, trying another) *Okay — try this one!*

Trend/dance clip #2 plays — rock-style trend. Cast head-bangs / air-guitars.

ASSISTANT DIRECTOR (nodding along) *Hm... this has some style. Rough, but I like the energy.*

THORWALD's foot taps despite himself — he catches it and stays stiff again.

MAKEUP MASTER (exasperated, fixing someone's hair) *Please don't sweat off all my*

hard work with this dancing!

PROP MASTER (hopeful) *One more! For everyone — even the parents!*

Trend/dance clip #3 plays — classic crowd-favorite hit.

CAMERA MAN (thrilled, standing) *NOW we're talking! THIS is cinema! Everyone up — parents too!*

LISA (already dancing, laughing) *This is my favorite one — come on, everybody!*

CAST (together, waving audience up) *Come on, everyone! Dance with us!*

Full cast + audience dance, ~30–45 seconds. THORWALD taps his foot, almost smiles — then crosses his arms when he notices someone watching.

DIRECTOR (catching breath, delighted) *Alright — back to work! But we're keeping that song for the ending!*

CEREMONY MASTER VALERIA (voice lower, serious) Now, the mood on set is about to change. This next scene is the big one — the one every actor fears and dreams about. Watch closely.

SCENE THREE: THE VILLAIN'S FEAR (Climax)

High-tension lighting. Before the scene starts, THORWALD stands alone, breathing hard.

THORWALD (alone, scared) *This is it... What if I'm too scary and everyone thinks I'm mean for real?*

JEFF/JESSY (noticing, calm — a role reversal from earlier) Thorwald? You don't have to pretend with me — I saw you dancing earlier. You're not that scary. And if you mess up, we help you. That's what we do here.

CAMERA MAN (excited, raising board) *Can I call it this time, Director?*

DIRECTOR nods, amused.

CAMERA MAN (thrilled, official voice) *Scene Three, Take One! ...ACTION!*

FILM SCENE BEGINS. JEFF/JESSY is alone, watching THORWALD'S window. THORWALD stands menacingly in shadow.

THORWALD (slow, threatening) *You've been watching me.*

JEFF/JESSY (voice shaking, acting scared) *I know what you did.*

THORWALD (looming, reaching out) *Then... you must be SIL—*

THORWALD freezes mid-line. His hand stays raised. He cannot finish.

THORWALD (breaking character, real fear) *I... I can't. I'm sorry. What if they think I'm mean in real life too?*

Everyone stops. Silence. Backstage and play collide.

DIRECTOR (soft, kneeling to his level) *Cut... it's okay, Thorwald. Take a breath.*

ASSISTANT DIRECTOR (sitting beside him) *I was scared my first time too. Everyone gets scared sometimes. That's normal.*

MAKEUP MASTER (gentle) *Being scary in a play doesn't make you scary in real life. You are ready.*

LISA (kneeling too, warm) *I've watched you rehearse. You are brave, Thorwald.*

PROP MASTER (holding out a small rock) *Take my lucky rock! It gives you courage!*

DETECTIVE (grinning, lightening the mood) *And hey — I forgot my line twice today! You don't see me crying!*

ARTIST (holding up the clay shape) *Look — I made a horse. It looked like a potato at first. I messed up. I kept going. That's what art is!*

CAMERA MAN (sitting with him) *I've dropped my camera three times today. We all make mistakes. But we get back up.*

MISS LONELYHEARTS (gentle, sincere) *We are all here for you, Thorwald. On a film set, everyone matters.*

JEFF/JESSY (kneeling closer, gentle) *You don't have to BE scary, Thorwald. Just play scary. We're still friends after.*

Everyone laughs softly. THORWALD breathes, stands, holds the lucky rock tight.

THORWALD (quiet but steady, standing) *Okay. I'm ready. Let's try again.*

DIRECTOR (proud) *Scene Three, Take Two! ...ACTION!*

FILM SCENE RESUMES. This time THORWALD holds strong.

THORWALD (finding his voice, controlled) *Then... you must be SILENCED!*

JEFF/JESSY (loud, brave, genuinely reacting) *HELP! POLICE! HELP!*

DIRECTOR (jumping up, thrilled) *CUT! CUT! PERFECT!*

SCENE FOUR: THE RELIEF (Falling Action)

Everyone cheers for THORWALD. He looks stunned, then breaks into a real smile.

THORWALD (laughing, relieved) *I did it! I actually did it!*

LISA (teasing, nudging him) *See? Rehearsal pays off!*

The classic song from the Playlist Problem starts softly. THORWALD taps his foot, then finally gives in and dances a little, laughing at himself.

DETECTIVE (pointing, delighted) *HA! Scary women DO dance!*

PROP MASTER (happy, clapping) *Best take of the whole day, if you ask me!*

JEFF/JESSY (camera down, grinning) *Told you. Not so scary after all.*

CEREMONY MASTER VALERIA (smiling, relieved) What a day on set! Mistakes, songs, fear, and courage — sounds like real Hollywood to me. Let's see how it all wraps up.

FINALE: THE CURTAIN CALL (Resolution)

Cast gathers in a line, facing the audience.

MISS LONELYHEARTS (warm) *On a film set, everyone matters.*

ARTIST (nodding) *When one person is scared, we lift them up. When one falls, we help them stand.*

THORWALD (genuine, no more bravado) *Even villains get scared sometimes. Real bravery is trying anyway.*

CAMERA MAN (to audience) *That's what Rear Window was really about. Not just a mystery — people working together.*

MAKEUP MASTER (smiling) *And helping each other look — and feel — their best.*

ASSISTANT DIRECTOR (nodding) *Every job matters here, big or small.*

LISA (warm) *Even the smallest kindness makes a difference.*

PROP MASTER (smiling) *Because in the end, the magic isn't on the screen. The magic is*

here — in the chaos, the laughter, the teamwork.

DETECTIVE (grinning) *And the dancing. Don't forget the dancing!*

JEFF/JESSY (proud) *And sometimes, watching isn't enough — you have to step in and help. That's the bravest thing.*

DIRECTOR (proud, to the whole cast) *Everyone — that's a wrap! Great work, all of you!*

ALL CHARACTERS (together, arms wide) *Thank you all!*

All cast bow together. Song #3 from the Playlist Problem plays again — bubbles or confetti fall, given to parents — and everyone, cast and audience, dances and waves together.

CEREMONY MASTER VALERIA (proud, to audience) And that's a wrap! Thank you for watching our 4th graders bring Hollywood to our classroom. Let's give them one more round of applause!

THE END